

D688

Foundations of Literacy Through Literature

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A third-grade teacher who runs the school's reading club finds that a novel falls within the grade's Lexile band. The cover art is beautiful, but the story jumps between two time periods, uses flashbacks without signals, and assumes knowledge of World War II. What is the best judgment about its complexity for most third graders?

- A.** It is a good fit, because the Lexile matches the grade band.
- B.** It is a good fit, because the cover art will hold attention.
- C.** It is likely more complex than the Lexile suggests, because its structure and knowledge demands are high.
- D.** It is too easy, because Lexile scores always overstate difficulty.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A second-grade class reads a short story that a grandparent volunteer donated: a hare mocks a slow tortoise, naps during a race, and loses. It ends with "Slow and steady wins the race." The book has a sturdy hardcover. Which genre is it?

- A.** A legend.
- B.** Realistic fiction.
- C.** A fable.
- D.** A myth.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants a myth for a genre study. Which story fits?

- A.** A story about an ant and a grasshopper that ends with a lesson about planning ahead.
- B.** A story in which a sky god's anger creates thunder and lightning.
- C.** A story about a real outlaw whose deeds grew larger with each telling.
- D.** A story about a lumberjack so big he dug a lake with his shovel.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

In a story read during a school-wide reading week, two friends argue over a lost library book, blame each other, and finally apologize and work together to find it. The author visited the school last year. Which is the best statement of theme?

- A. Two friends lose a library book and find it.
- B. Friendship.
- C. Authors should visit schools.
- D. Working together solves problems better than blaming each other.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student says a story’s theme is “courage.” What is the best feedback?

- A. “Stories never have themes about courage.”
- B. “That’s the topic. What does the story say about courage? Write it as a sentence.”
- C. “Correct — themes are one word.”
- D. “Tell me the main character’s name.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A first-grade teacher with a cozy reading corner and new beanbags is picking a daily read-aloud. Most students are just learning to decode short words. Which choice best supports language and knowledge growth?

- A. A rich picture book with advanced vocabulary and ideas the students could not yet read on their own.
- B. Any book, since the beanbags make reading fun.
- C. Decodable books the students can already read.
- D. Only books with fewer than 50 words, since young children cannot follow more.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A fourth-grade teacher auditing her classroom library, which fills three tall shelves, finds several books about Native American peoples. One shows all characters in feathered headdresses living in the past; another, by a tribal author, shows a present-day family at a basketball game and a community gathering. Both books have awards stickers. Which judgment best reflects authentic representation?

- A. Keep both equally, since any book about a group adds diversity.
- B. Remove all books about Native peoples to avoid mistakes.
- C. Keep both because both won awards.
- D. Keep and feature the book by the tribal author; flag the other for stereotyped, past-only portrayal.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8.

A fifth grader reading a novel with a shiny gold medal on its cover notices it says: “Mara wondered if her brother was angry. He stared out the window, and she could not tell what he was thinking.” The novel is 220 pages long. What is the point of view?

- A. Third-person omniscient.
- B. Second person.
- C. First person.
- D. Third-person limited.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants an example of first-person point of view. Which sentence fits?

- A. “I held my breath as the lights went out.”
- B. “They all held their breath, each fearing something different.”
- C. “She held her breath as the lights went out.”
- D. “You hold your breath as the lights go out.”

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A third-grade class has just finished a poem about the first snowfall. The school sits in a region that gets heavy snow each winter. The teacher wants students to take an aesthetic stance. Which prompt fits?

- A. "What did you see, hear, and feel as you read? Which line stayed with you?"
- B. "How many inches of snow does our region get each year?"
- C. "List three facts about snow from the poem."
- D. "Count the syllables in each line."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student reads an article about bats to find out what they eat. Which stance is the student taking?

- A. Both at the same moment, always.
- B. Critical literacy.
- C. Efferent.
- D. Aesthetic.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A second-grade team with a generous book budget is planning a two-week unit around a picture book about a girl who helps care for sea turtles. The school library recently extended its hours. Which plan best builds knowledge and vocabulary?

- A. Read the same story every day for two weeks only.
- B. Pair the story with informational books and a video about sea turtles' life cycle and habitats.
- C. Follow it with unrelated picture books so each day is a new topic.
- D. Send students to the library during its new hours to choose any book.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A third-grade teacher ~~who runs the school's reading club~~ finds that a novel falls within the grade's Lexile band. ~~The cover art is beautiful,~~ but the story jumps between two time periods, uses flashbacks without signals, and assumes knowledge of World War II. What is the best judgment about its complexity for most third graders?

Target word: judge complexity **Decides:** Qualitative features raise the difficulty beyond the number.

A	Dropped element	Drops the qualitative and reader/task dimensions.
B	Camouflage	Art does not decide text complexity.
C	Correct	Qualitative features and reader knowledge can outweigh a quantitative score.
D	Absolute language	No score always over- or understates.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A second-grade class reads a short story ~~that a grandparent volunteer donated:~~ a hare mocks a slow tortoise, naps during a race, and loses. It ends with "Slow and steady wins the race." ~~The book has a sturdy hardcover.~~ Which genre is it?

Target word: identify the subgenre **Decides:** Animal characters plus a stated moral.

A	Adjacent category	Legends exaggerate real historical people or events.
B	Inverted operation	Talking animals rule out realism.
C	Correct	Short tale with animal characters that ends with a stated moral.
D	Confusion set	Myths explain nature or origins, usually through gods.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

A teacher wants a myth for a genre study. Which story fits?

Target word: choose by genre — reverse of naming it **Decides:** Explains nature or origins through supernatural beings.

A	Confusion set	A fable — animals and a moral.
B	Correct	Explains a natural event through a god.
C	Adjacent category	A legend.
D	Inverted operation	A tall tale — exaggeration for humor, not explaining nature.

4. Answer D Concept 3

In a story read ~~during a school-wide reading week,~~ two friends argue over a lost library book, blame each other, and finally apologize and work together to find it. ~~The author visited the school last year.~~ Which is the best statement of theme?

Target word: state the theme **Decides:** A theme is a sentence-length message about life.

A	Adjacent category	A plot summary, not a theme.
B	Dropped element	A topic; it drops the message.
C	Camouflage	Keys on the visit; nothing in the story says it.
D	Correct	A complete message the story teaches about life.

5. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

A student says a story's theme is "courage." What is the best feedback?

Target word: fix a topic offered as theme **Decides:** Themes are full-sentence messages.

A	Absolute language	Courage is a common thematic topic.
B	Correct	Moves the student from topic to message.
C	Inverted operation	Confirms the error.
D	Adjacent category	A character question, not theme.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A first-grade teacher ~~with a cozy reading corner and new beanbags~~ is picking a daily read-aloud. Most students are just learning to decode short words. Which choice best supports language and knowledge growth?

Target word: read-aloud selection **Decides:** Listening comprehension is ahead of reading ability.

A	Correct	Read-alouds stretch vocabulary and knowledge beyond decoding level.
B	Camouflage	Comfort does not decide instructional value.
C	Confusion set	Right for decoding practice, but too simple to build language as a read-aloud.
D	Absolute language	Young children follow much richer language when it is read to them.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A fourth-grade teacher auditing her classroom library, ~~which fills three tall shelves~~, finds several books about Native American peoples. One shows all characters in feathered headdresses living in the past; another, by a tribal author, shows a present-day family at a basketball game and a community gathering. ~~Both books have awards stickers.~~ Which judgment best reflects authentic representation?

Target word: evaluate representation **Decides:** Stereotyped, past-only portrayals vs. an authentic present-day view.

A	Dropped element	Drops the check for stereotypes and accuracy.
B	Absolute language	Removes mirrors and windows students need.
C	Camouflage	Awards do not guarantee authentic representation.
D	Correct	Authentic, contemporary portrayals serve as accurate mirrors and windows.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A fifth grader reading a novel ~~with a shiny gold medal on its cover~~ notices it says: "Mara wondered if her brother was angry. He stared out the window, and she could not tell what he was thinking." ~~The novel is 220 pages long.~~ What is the point of view?

Target word: identify point of view **Decides:** Third person, one character's thoughts only.

A	Confusion set	Omniscient would reveal the brother's thoughts too.
B	Inverted operation	Second person addresses the reader as "you."
C	Adjacent category	First person would use "I."
D	Correct	Uses "she," shows Mara's thoughts, and cannot see her brother's.

9. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

A teacher wants an example of first-person point of view. Which sentence fits?

Target word: choose by point of view **Decides:** Narrator uses “I” and tells their own experience.

A	Correct	The narrator is a character using “I.”
B	Adjacent category	Third-person omniscient — knows several characters’ feelings.
C	Confusion set	Third person.
D	Inverted operation	Second person.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A third-grade class has just finished a poem about the first snowfall. ~~The school sits in a region that gets heavy snow each winter.~~ The teacher wants students to take an aesthetic stance. Which prompt fits?

Target word: aesthetic prompt **Decides:** Aesthetic = the lived experience and feelings of reading.

A	Correct	Invites the lived, emotional experience of the poem.
B	Camouflage	Uses the region detail; not about reading the poem.
C	Inverted operation	An efferent, information-taking prompt.
D	Adjacent category	A structural analysis, not an aesthetic response.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

A student reads an article about bats to find out what they eat. Which stance is the student taking?

Target word: name the stance from purpose **Decides:** Reading to take away information.

A	Absolute language	Stances sit on a continuum; this purpose is efferent.
B	Adjacent category	Questions power and perspective in text — not the purpose here.
C	Correct	The reader seeks information to carry away.
D	Inverted operation	Aesthetic is reading for the experience itself.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A second-grade team ~~with a generous book budget~~ is planning a two-week unit around a picture book about a girl who helps care for sea turtles. ~~The school library recently extended its hours.~~ Which plan best builds knowledge and vocabulary?

Target word: text-sequence plan **Decides:** Connected texts on one topic build knowledge.

A	Dropped element	Repetition helps, but drops the informational partner texts.
B	Correct	A text set on one topic gives repeated exposure to ideas and words.
C	Inverted operation	Scatters topics and loses the knowledge-building effect.
D	Camouflage	Uses the library detail; free choice alone does not build a connected set.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Three parts of text complexity	Text complexity is judged by quantitative measures (like Lexile), qualitative features (meaning, structure, language, knowledge demands), and reader and task considerations.	Choosing a book by its Lexile score alone.	A book whose number looks right but whose content or structure does not.
2	Traditional literature subgenres	Fables teach a stated moral, often with animal characters; myths explain nature or origins through gods or supernatural beings; legends exaggerate a historical person or event; tall tales stretch a hero's deeds for humor.	Calling every old story with talking animals a myth.	A story's purpose — teach a lesson, explain nature, or glorify a hero.
3	Theme vs. topic	A topic is what a story is about in a word or phrase; a theme is the author's message about life, stated as a full sentence.	Giving a one-word topic ("friendship") as the theme.	"What is the theme?" with single-word options.
4	Read-alouds above reading level	Young students' listening comprehension outpaces their reading, so read-alouds of complex texts build vocabulary, knowledge, and syntax they cannot yet read alone.	Limiting read-alouds to texts students can read independently.	Choosing a read-aloud for a class of beginning readers.
5	Mirrors, windows, and authentic representation	A strong classroom library lets students see themselves (mirrors) and others (windows) through authentic, non-stereotyped portrayals, often by authors with inside knowledge.	Counting diverse covers without checking for stereotypes or accuracy.	Evaluating or building a classroom library.
6	Point of view	First person uses "I" and one character's view; third-person limited follows one character's thoughts; third-person omniscient knows many characters' thoughts.	Assuming any "he/she" narration is omniscient.	Pronouns and whose thoughts the reader can see.
7	Efferent vs. aesthetic reading	Rosenblatt's efferent stance reads to take away information; the aesthetic stance reads for the lived experience and feelings of the text.	Treating every story reading as fact-extraction.	A response prompt that asks for facts vs. one that asks what the reader felt or pictured.
8	Paired texts and text sets	Pairing literature with informational texts on one topic builds background knowledge and repeated exposure to vocabulary.	Choosing unrelated texts so each day is a fresh topic.	Planning a sequence of texts for a unit.

Course scope (public description): Foundations of Literacy through Literature is an enriching course designed for educators and literacy enthusiasts, focusing on the exploration and utilization of literature to foster growth in the skills and concepts necessary for reading. This course delves into the role of varied and age-appropriate literary works in the science of reading to develop reading, writing, speaking, and listening abilities in learners. Students examine a broad range of genres to understand how different texts can be used to enhance vocabulary, comprehension, and critical thinking. This analysis allows the candidate to not only successfully integrate literature into meaningful instruction, but it is designed to cultivate a deep appreciation for reading itself. The curriculum emphasizes interactive and creative teaching strategies to engage learners effectively and integrate culture into their literacy instruction. The candidate is given real-world examples for how to create an inclusive environment that respects and celebrates different perspectives through quality text. By the end of the course, students are prepared with the knowledge and practical skills to use literature as a powerful tool in the development of comprehensive literacy skills.